

Strange customs

Hello Vinit,
Since India's customs laws suck and we end up paying high prices for the latest computer hardware such as a GeForce4 graphics card, why can't an Indian company produce these locally? This would definitely reduce prices and make these hardware components more affordable for the common computer user.

Sandeep Banerjee
Via e-mail

Hello Sandeep,

Manufacturing hardware locally would definitely result in lower-priced products. However, the process of fabricating devices such as graphics cards is very demanding and needs huge capital investments and infrastructure—two factors that are in short supply in India. While there are companies that have set up manufacturing plants for devices such as motherboards and modems, it is not financially viable to manufacture top-of-the-line products such as the latest graphics cards. In fact, Graig Barrett, CEO of Intel, said he would set up a chip fabrication plant in India if he were guaranteed clean power. And that was over one-and-a-half years ago!

digit

Read our letters

Hi Vinit,

I have a suggestion. In your November 2002 issue you said that you couldn't reply to everyone's mail due to the sheer number of e-mails received by you. May I suggest that you implement a program that sorts the mails and forwards it to the proper person? If you are too busy, I will make that program for you.

Nick Carter
Via e-mail

Hi Nick,

Thanks for your input and I greatly appreciate your offer for help. However, most mail clients have filters that can do what you have suggested. But this is not the problem. We literally receive hundreds of e-mails everyday and it is just not feasible for our editorial staff to devote the time required to do justice to each of the queries that they receive while balancing their regular workload. We do, however, find the time to read through everything that our readers have to say even though we might not be able to reply to every e-mail.

digit

Singing away the blues!

Hi Vinit,

I work for a company that manufactures DSL-based Internet access equipment. As a professional involved in the telecom sector, I think I can explain the underlying issue affecting Internet access in India as described in November's article 'Broadband Blues'. The so-called broadband that is presently being offered is an extension of Ethernet technology—a shared medium technology. Thus, as the users increase for a particular segment, the speed for that segment falls. The result is a typical customer reaction that when the service was started the speed was okay, but worsened as time progressed.

S.A. Srinivasa Moorthy

Via e-mail

digit

Hi Srinivasa,

You are absolutely right. Falling speeds as a result of an increase in the subscriber base is a primary problem affecting broadband services in India. Service providers need to strictly enforce Quality of Service and ensure that their bandwidth increases in proportion to the number of subscribers.

A great idea!

Hi Digit,

I would like to suggest a change for the 'By Demand' section on your Web site. It is hard to choose a game or software by just reading its name. You should include a small write up on these software or provide a suitable link so that the users can make a more informed decision.

Sarosh
Via e-mail



Hi Sarosh,

Dhanyavad for the excellent suggestion. In fact, we've already started to provide more information on the 'By Demand' candidates within the poll itself.

digit

Short Bytes

Miss October

Hi Vinit,

Your October edition was a real treat; the centre-spread workshop on 'Reviving your Dead PC' was especially outstanding. I am a hardware student and I found that piece to be of great help.

Shiva Kumar

Via e-mail

Spread the good word

Dear Vinit,

I have been reading your magazine since its inception and I love the articles and reviews. Lately I've run out of storage space, but I simply cannot get myself to give away Digit to the raddiwalla. Can you please suggest an alternative means to give the old issues away?

Chirag

Via e-mail

Since knowledge and wisdom are best shared, you could donate the old issues to your local library and give countless others an opportunity to learn about the wonderful world of technology.

Goof Ups

■ The Walking Gigabytes story on Page 74, Digit November 2002, incorrectly mentions that the Zip 250 and 750 do not feature a manual eject button. Both the Zip drives have the said button.

■ In November issue's Bazaar section, the contact information provided for Busy Lite 3.0 on Page 89 is incorrect. The correct contact is Busy Infotech Pvt Ltd, Phone: 011-7375062, Price: Rs 1,500.

■ The Drive-in Bytes story on Page 56 in the same issue mentions that the LG 8320B contains 8 MB of buffer. It in fact only has a 2 MB buffer. Thanks for pointing this one out, Vishwanath.

Notice any goof-ups? Write to goof@jasubhai.com

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